

関西学院大学 経済学部 英語 過去問風 演習

行動経済学 長文 一本番想定 (大問 1 題・25 分)

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高校3年～既卒 (関西学院大学 経済学部志望)

英語 (長文読解・関学経済本番レベル)

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Reading Comprehension (25 min, 30 pts) [配点 30 点]

Read the following passage on behavioral economics.

For most of the twentieth century, economists assumed that human beings made decisions like calculators — weighing costs and benefits, maximizing utility, choosing rationally. (A) This model of "homo economicus" was elegant in theory but bore little resemblance to actual human behavior.

The challenge to this assumption came from psychologists, most notably Daniel Kahneman and Amos Tversky. Through experiments conducted in the 1970s, they demonstrated that people consistently make decisions in ways that deviate from rational models. We weigh losses more heavily than equivalent gains. We are influenced by how choices are framed. We rely on mental shortcuts that can lead us astray.

(B) Kahneman's framework distinguishes between two systems of thinking: System 1, which is fast, intuitive, and emotional; and System 2, which is slow, deliberate, and logical. Most of our daily decisions are made by System 1, which is efficient but prone to systematic biases. System 2 can correct these errors, but only when we are alert and motivated.

The implications for economics — and for public policy — have been profound. (C) Governments worldwide have begun using "nudges" — small adjustments to choice architecture that guide behavior without restricting freedom. Automatically enrolling employees in retirement plans, for example, dramatically increases participation rates without requiring anyone to save against their will.

Critics worry that nudging is paternalistic, even manipulative. Supporters counter that since choice architecture is inevitable — there is no "neutral" way to present options — we should design it to help people achieve their own stated goals. The debate continues, but behavioral economics has permanently changed how we understand human decision-making.

Notes:

homo economicus — 経済人 (合理の人間像)

heuristics — 経験則・近道思考

nudge — ナッジ (行動誘導)

paternalistic — 父権主義的な

Reading Comprehension (25 min, 30 pts) — Questions

Q1

1

What does underlined sentence (A) suggest about the 'homo economicus' model?

- ① It accurately described real human behavior.
- ② It was theoretically elegant but did not match actual human behavior.
- ③ It was developed by Daniel Kahneman.
- ④ It has been confirmed by recent experiments.

Q2

2

According to underlined sentence (B), what characterizes System 1 thinking?

- ① Slow, deliberate, and logical
- ② Fast, intuitive, and emotional
- ③ Always rational and accurate
- ④ Used only by trained economists

Q3

3

Which is NOT mentioned as a way people deviate from rational decision-making?

- ① Weighing losses more heavily than equivalent gains
- ② Being influenced by how choices are framed
- ③ Relying on mental shortcuts
- ④ Always calculating exact probabilities

Q4

4

What example of a 'nudge' is given in underlined sentence (C) and the passage?

- ① Banning unhealthy food entirely
- ② Automatic enrollment in retirement plans
- ③ Punishing people who fail to save
- ④ Raising taxes on savings

Q5

5

What is the supporters' main response to critics of nudging?

- ① Nudging is always neutral and never affects choices.
- ② Since choice architecture is inevitable, it should be designed to help people achieve their own goals.
- ③ Nudging should be banned in all countries.
- ④ People should never make their own decisions.

Q6

6

Who are the two psychologists most credited with challenging the rational decision model?

- ① Adam Smith and John Maynard Keynes
- ② Daniel Kahneman and Amos Tversky
- ③ Milton Friedman and Friedrich Hayek
- ④ Sigmund Freud and Carl Jung

解答・解説

問	解答	解説
1	②	【正解】 ② 下線部 (A) 「elegant in theory but bore little resemblance to actual human behavior」と一致。
2	②	【正解】 ② 下線部 (B) 「System 1, which is fast, intuitive, and emotional」と一致。
3	④	【正解】 ④ 第2段落で挙げられるのは: 損失重視・フレーミング・mental shortcuts。「always calculating exact probabilities」はむしろ rational model の特徴で記述なし。
4	②	【正解】 ② 第4段落「Automatically enrolling employees in retirement plans ... dramatically increases participation rates」と一致。
5	②	【正解】 ② 最終段落「since choice architecture is inevitable ... we should design it to help people achieve their own stated goals」と一致。
6	②	【正解】 ② 第2段落「Daniel Kahneman and Amos Tversky」と明記。Kahneman は 2002 年ノーベル経済学賞受賞。